SEUNG-WA AKPAN

Applied AI & Backend Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Applied AI engineer building production speech and LLM systems in Python. Main engineer on OraScribe (orascribe.ai), a transcription and translation platform: GPU model serving on Modal, Celery job pipelines, billing, and the evals that test them. Checks changes with regression tests and measurements on real workloads.

CORE SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

AI & LLM: LLM evals, vLLM, Modal serverless GPUs, Whisper, Silero VAD, Qwen3, OpenAI, Gemini, RAG, embeddings, LangChain

Backend: Python, Flask, FastAPI, Celery, Node.js, TypeScript, NestJS, Express.js, REST APIs, webhooks, WebSockets, JWT, OAuth 2.0

Data & Infrastructure: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, ChromaDB, BullMQ, Docker, AWS, Linux, CI/CD, Sentry, S3 / MinIO

Testing & Tooling: pytest, Jest, OpenAPI, Claude Code and other coding agents

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Python Developer · *Kevin Winter Foundation* | Remote | January 2025 – Present

- Build and maintain OraScribe's AI pipeline for transcription, translation and summaries on Flask, Celery, Redis and Modal serverless GPUs, using Whisper for speech-to-text and vLLM for LLM serving.
- Cut LLM cold-start time on staging from 266s to 13–30s in most runs by restoring a saved GPU memory snapshot.
- Tested Qwen3-4B against the M2M100 translation model on 15 idioms before building an LLM translation path behind a flag: word-for-word mistranslations fell from 11 to at most 1, and a 122-segment job went from 86s to 21s.
- Found the voice activity filter was silently dropping sung speech; after the fix, one 8-minute recording went from 120 to 421 transcribed words. Added a loudness-based check so similar losses show up in metrics.
- Built an eval suite that checks transcripts for dropped speech: fast no-GPU tests on every commit, plus a 5-minute real-GPU run that fails on the old settings that lost speech and passes on production.
- Moved 30–100+ minute GPU jobs off a single long-held connection, which dropped and lost jobs on deploys, to a submit, poll and reconcile flow behind a rollback flag.

Backend Developer · *KSolutions* | Nigeria | Part-time | February 2025 – March 2026

National Youth Service Corps: Nigeria's mandatory one-year graduate service placement

- Developed the backend for a people-matching application using Node.js, Express, and SQL, covering appointment scheduling and match status management.
- Built user matching with compatibility scoring, plus an admin API for match coordinators.

Backend Engineering Intern · *HNG Tech* | Remote | Part-time | October 2025 – December 2025

Open-enrolment engineering fellowship; reached finalist stage

- Built APIs with Node.js, TypeScript and NestJS for an AI chat platform.
- Integrated Google Gemini for chat replies that use stored history in MongoDB.
- Added real-time messaging over Socket.IO, Redis-based rate limiting and S3-compatible (MinIO) file uploads.

Backend Developer Intern · *Resourceful Dev* | Abuja, Nigeria | July 2023 – September 2023

- Built a Blog API in Node.js and Express with JWT auth, role-based access, Redis caching and Jest tests.

SELECTED PROJECTS

HP Community | *Astro · Progressive Web App · Cloudflare*
hpcommunity.app · read.hpcommunity.app

- Built and run two live progressive web apps for a faith community: a companion app (about 25 weekly active users over three months, peaking at 38, tracked in PostHog) and a reading library.
- The library serves 7,400+ paragraphs across two books with full-text search and annotation, plus reading plans whose daily target recalculates from each reader's actual progress.

Document RAG Service | *NestJS · TypeScript · ChromaDB · LangChain · OpenRouter · Docker*
github.com/seung-waedet/document-rag-service

- Retrieval-augmented generation API that ingests PDF, DOCX, and TXT files, chunks and embeds them into ChromaDB, and answers natural-language questions with an LLM.
- Chunks with LangChain's RecursiveCharacterTextSplitter and calls Llama 3 through OpenRouter, so the model provider can change; ChromaDB runs in Docker Compose.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.Sc. Computer Science, First Class Honours (CGPA 4.73 / 5.00), Arthur Jarvis University, Nigeria | 2021 – 2024

Diploma in Backend Engineering, AltSchool Africa | 2023 – 2024

LEADERSHIP

Google Developer Student Club, Founding Lead · *Arthur Jarvis University* | August 2022 – August 2023

- Founded and led the university's first GDSC chapter, organising 12+ technical workshops on web development, APIs, and cloud technologies.